

**NDOLA CITY COUNCIL
CITY PLANNING DEPARTMENT**

**REPORT ON THE FORMATION AND TRAINING OF COMMUNITY
WATER SCHEME MANAGEMENT COMMITTEES.**

District	Ndola
Location	Mwange A and Zambia compound Kan'gonga production Centre
Thematic Area	Water, Sanitation and Hygiene
Activity Title	Formation and Training of Water Scheme management committees
Purpose of activity	Conduct orientation of Water Scheme Management Committees for 2 Communities in the District.
Planned Targets	Train 2 Community Water Scheme Management Committees.
Start Date	12 th November, 2025
End Date	13 th November, 2025
Reporting period	Quarter 4, 2025
Facilitating Team	Lewis Kaluba - WASH Coordinator - MLGRD Lwiza Chisola - Environmental Planner-MLGRD Ganizani Nthere – Assistant Water Engineer- DWRD

Results Achieved Against planned target

What was accomplished, against what was targeted?

During the activity, the team managed to orient 2 out of 2 Community Water Scheme Management Committees (Mwange A and Zambia Compound kan'gonga Production center)

with each having 9 members with the gender disaggregated as in the table below.

Female	Male	23-60 years	Total
8	10	18	18

The Water Scheme Management Committees were taken through the following topics:

1. Environmental Health-

During the session, participants were asked to define sanitation and hygiene is to them, as well as the different toilets that are present in their communities. Trainers also asked participants to identify the different ways in which human waste is disposed of in their

community, with the goal being that committee members can move their communities from open defecation towards homes that have latrines and handwashing facilities.

2. Sustainable Operation and Maintenance of the Water Sources

Committee members are briefed on the importance of operation and management, common mechanized system problems, preventive maintenance and routine operation maintenance activities, for example caretakers are encouraged not to allow animals near the water point, prevent children from playing around the scheme, and ensure that laundry is done away from the water source.

3. Budgeting and Financial Management

During the session, participants discussed proper accountability for managing the water scheme funds. Participants were taken through the budgeting process, resource mobilization and management and utilization of maintenance funds.

4. Work Plan Implementation

With the help of the trainers each water scheme committee developed an action plan on regular meetings with the water users (community members) to start collecting fees for the maintenance of the Water Scheme to ensure sustainability.

- **What were the immediate reactions of the activity participants/targeted beneficiaries in relation to the activity?**

Chairperson for Mwange A water scheme management Committee said “they have acquired the knowledge on how to manage the water scheme and improve sanitation and hygiene in their households and the community in order to live a healthy life in a healthy environment.

Challenges and Lessons Learned

The formation of Water Scheme management Committees can be a valuable approach to promoting sustainable water and sanitation practices within communities. However, several challenges were identified during the formation and operation:

1. **Limited Awareness and Understanding:** Communities lacked awareness of the importance of WASH practices and did not fully understand the roles and responsibilities of Water scheme Management Committees.
2. **Sustainability:** Ensuring the long-term sustainability of Water scheme management Committees is Challenging due to insufficient local ownership or commitment. Communities struggle to maintain the momentum and resources needed to sustain WASH infrastructures over time.
3. **Resource Constraints:** Limited financial resources, inadequate infrastructure, and a lack of access to technical expertise impedes the formation and functioning of Water scheme Management committees.
4. **Capacity Building:** Building the capacity of community members to manage and maintain WASH infrastructure and services is essential for the success of Water scheme management Committees. Providing training and ongoing support in areas such as governance, leadership, and technical skills can strengthen committee effectiveness.
5. **Gender Dynamics:** Gender inequalities may affect the composition and functioning of water scheme management Committees, with women and other marginalized groups

often underrepresented in decision-making processes. Ensuring gender balance and promoting the meaningful participation of all community members is crucial for equitable WASH outcomes.

Addressing these challenges requires a multifaceted approach that emphasizes community engagement, capacity building, and sustainable resource management. By empowering communities to take ownership of their WASH initiatives, WASH Committees can play a vital role in improving health outcomes and promoting social development.

Observations and Recommendations

- Committee members showed a sense of responsibility through active participation during the activity
- Community members to provide protection and maintenance of the community water schemes.
- Periodic inspection of water schemes by the local authority and EHTs
- Involvement of local leadership e.g., WDCs in the governance of water schemes.
- **Coordination and Collaboration:** Effective coordination and collaboration among various stakeholders, including government agencies, NGOs, and community-based organizations, are essential for supporting the activities of WASH Committees. Building strong partnerships can enhance resource mobilization, knowledge sharing, and mutual support.

Prepared by LEWIS KALIBA
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Date 20/11/25

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